they got stuck in the middle and never finished? The book would, in that case, never be done.

I said, "Is it all right if I sell first serial rights and have it appear in a magazine first?"

"Yes," I was told.

So I did just that. I talked it over with Campbell on my mid-June visit to New York and then spent the rest of the month working on the story (which Campbell suggested I call "Sucker Bait").

My caution paid off. Poul Anderson wrote his story (and eventually also sold it to Campbell), but I don't think Virginia got around to writing hers—and Twayne Press folded anyway. By then it didn't matter. I sold it to Campbell, who paid me $1,000 for its 25,000 words.

9

With July 1, my school salary went to $6,000 per year, but $1,000 was still slated to come from the student-nurse course. That was not good, since if the nurse-teaching turned sour, I might find myself back at $5,000, where I had started over four years before.

The money was not vital, but the insult involved in a salary cutback was. I made up my mind that if that was threatened, I would resign.

10

But why worry? It was time for vacation. This year, Gertrude determined that it would be Henry and she and I who would take a week off, while Mary would stay with David.

I was not sure this would work. David was now two months short of being two years old—very active and very strong-willed—and Mary might not be able to handle him.

Mary expressed her willingness, however, and Gertrude hadn't been away from David for nearly two years, so we chanced it.

We went to a resort named "Merriewoode" this time. It was on an island and there was a pleasant sense of isolation in knowing that people could only arrive, or leave, on a boat.